

COCOON

When I touched a man's hand , his cold bare soft hand , I felt like I belonged to him and he belonged to me. At that very moment , I found myself falling for a man and not a woman.

When I looked into his eyes , that silent exchange of glances , it felt like we traversed centuries together. Like there was no need for words , As our hearts communicated in a language known only to them . When I saw his moist eyelashes , curled up in uneven spaces , at that very moment , I found myself falling in love for a man and not a woman.

When our lips met , tears flowed through my eyes , releasing the burden of suppressed emotions. With a gentle sweep of his hand across my cheek , not only did he touch my skin but also the depths of my soul. At that very moment , I found myself falling in love for a man and not a woman.

I yearned to gaze at the moon under the open sky but the radiance of moon's glow unveils him to the world. The world can see him but he shall remain unseen. I draw the curtains close , so that not even the stars cannot witness his presence. We lived in our little cocoon clung to each other , ensuring it doesn't fall apart.

As the sun casted its revealing glow , our paths crossed once again. Yet , in that bright moment , he chose to remain a shadow , for the light had the power to expose the hidden truths he wished to conceal. Our glances remained untouched , I looked at my light walking straight as he looked at the light of the day , safeguarding the mysteries he carried within.

While our love was whispering in silence , they declared it a sin with their loud echoes. How can love , the purest of sentiments , a force that unites souls and brings life into existence , be a sin? They said it was wrong and disgusting. Why , then , what I felt , what he felt , didn't feel wrong ? Isn't it a sin to deny the authenticity of one's own heart ?

When I touched that scar on his left arm , given by those who tried to mold love , by mere electric currents , calling it shock therapy , trying to bend the course of hearts , using volts and wires , which still persist in the form of prejudiced stares , whispered gossips and discriminations , When I touched that scar , I felt what he felt and in that very moment , I fell in love with a man and not a woman. I couldn't breathe and I opened the window , I saw a bunch of hands knocking on the glass creating a web to suffocate the very air of acceptance. It was a suffocation , not of breath , but of the right to love freely . Those fingers casted shadows over us hiding the colors of affection , extinguishing all the flame that we had within us.

He was forced to go through a test to prove that he is not a sinner . With the questioning eyes parading him , he faced images capturing the spectrum of human bodies , men , women , a blend of both , clothed , or laid bare in their entirety , the authenticity of his being was measured by snapshots . The heartbeats we used to listen to together were put on a machine , where each change was observed , with the expectations of proving him a criminal against the crime of

loving , not a woman but a man. His every blink was analyzed in that test , every boundary was crossed in that test , every action was judged in that test. The right to be seen , understood or loved was taken away when he was asked whether he has loved a man in his life. He denied and the machine agreed. Did the man I loved never loved me back or has he been living the lie so truthfully that the line between truth and lie blurred and he made himself believe the lie to be the truth ? Was the machine a fool in all of this or was I ?

We still shared many smiles , many tears and many touches . In the awareness that tomorrows are never guaranteed , each goodbye carried a bittersweet weight , became a sweet reminder to hold each other a little tighter , for a little longer. Every moment was a celebration of the now , where the present held promises of forever yet unknown if the light will enter our cocoon and reveal our shadows.

Soon before I painted him in my arms , they threw stones on the canvas leaving our painting unfinished. The demands of this rigid world won over heart's soft desires and the man I loved , married a woman . The brush left my hand and the script was now written by societal norms. That canvas remained hidden in the silent corner of unspoken words and unfulfilled promises.

He sacrificed the truth , He chose that mask , married her and concealed our love. In the silent solitude of nights , he yearned for the touch , the warmth that the world found unacceptable. The inferno of his love not only burned his heart but also casted flames upon the woman who was unknown. Their hearts , with a void growing each passing day , pulsated the echoes of what could have been . The touch of his wife's hands became a reminder of a love unfinished , unattained , and her laughter , a melody of the silence within. The scars of the choices , made us wonder about the future that was now beyond our reach and those past confessions being just a dream.

As I became trapped in the inevitable cage of elderliness , loneliness and terminal illness , he knew this was the final farewell , fate conspired to reunite us. I met him again for the very last time and our eyes met for the very last time . Every word he spoke had a sense of unspoken echo , reflecting forgiveness , regret and the glitter in his eyes was now just immense pain. That sense of belonging was still there , it was almost like I could feel the heaviness he was feeling. In his arms , I found the lost peace. As I took my last breaths , the air that escaped my lips , was the very air that cradled him. He stood beside me , in that touch of glance , I saw acceptance. He screamed , as loud as he could , refusing to be silenced , each word of his resonating with each heartbeat of mine , he said , "This man is the love of my life". In the grace of his forehead kiss , my heart , with his fragrance on my body , stopped beating as I heard the sound of a cocoon breaking. At that very moment , I found myself falling for that man for the eternity.

